

Some of the most prominent features visible on both the Kryptos main piece and over the smaller scale model are the “S” shape of the sculpture and the “EN D^YAH^R ...” oddity at the beginning of the lower part of the encoded section.

I believe it to be of widespread knowledge that D^YAH^R is an anagram of HYDRA, a serpent like sea-monster from Greek mythology with many heads (7, 9 or more depending on the source) that shed poisonous fumes and was slayed by Heracles as one of his twelve labors.

This observation is consistent with other features from the ensemble, such as the pools of water and the serpentine shape of the main piece. The fact that Sanborn used other mythological references on his works (MEDUSA on the Cyrillic cylinder and the HYDRA solid ice video come to mind) seems to validate the claim that it would be reasonable to assume it to be a purposely-crafted reference and not an anagrammatic coincidence.

A second oddity can be seen when transcribing K3 with a fixed font where the word HEAD can be read perpendicular from the “H” in D^YAH^R:

E	N	D	Y	A	H	R	O	H	N	L	S	R	H	E	O	C	P	T	E	O	I	B	I	D	Y	S	H	N	A	I	A	
C	H	T	N	R	E	Y	U	L	D	S	L	L	S	L	N	O	H	S	N	O	S	M	R	W	X	M	N	E				
T	P	R	N	G	A	T	I	H	N	R	A	R	P	E	S	L	N	N	E	L	E	B	L	P	I	I	A	C	A	E		
W	M	T	W	N	D	I	T	E	E	N	R	A	H	C	T	E	N	E	U	D	R	E	T	N	H	A	E	O	E			
T	F	O	L	S	E	D	T	I	W	E	N	H	A	E	I	O	Y	T	E	Y	Q	H	E	E	N	C	T	A	Y	C	R	
E	I	F	T	B	R	S	P	A	M	H	H	E	W	E	N	A	T	A	M	A	T	E	G	Y	E	E	R	L	B			
T	E	E	F	O	A	S	F	I	O	T	U	E	T	U	A	E	O	T	O	A	R	M	A	E	E	R	T	N	R	T	I	
B	S	E	D	D	N	I	A	A	H	T	T	M	S	T	E	W	P	I	E	R	O	A	G	R	I	E	W	F	E	B		
A	E	C	T	D	D	H	I	L	C	E	I	H	S	I	T	E	G	O	E	A	O	S	D	D	R	Y	D	L	O	R	I	T
R	K	L	M	L	E	H	A	G	T	D	H	A	R	D	P	N	E	O	H	M	G	F	M	F	E	U	H	E				
E	C	D	M	R	I	P	F	E	I	M	E	H	N	L	S	S	T	T	R	T	V	D	O	H	W	?						

Further exploring the HYDRA theme, let us assume that EN D^YAH^R could be representing a binary hint. We do know Sanborn has used ASCII binary in several other works so is familiar with it and we also have a possible reference on the morse code fragment that reads “DIGeTAL INTERPRETAT”. ASCII is encoded with 7 bits with the first two (most significant bits) being always identical when representing the alphabet letters, allowing us to safely strip these first two bits, in a way similar to the “EN” being separated from the remaining DYAH^R, leaving us with the 5 bits necessary represent the set of 26 alphabet characters.

Working with just D^YAH^R we can further observe that the raised bits are curiously the only ones needed to represent the letters H E A D:

H = 01000
E = 00101
A = 00001
D = 00100

Taking the interpretation of these features in a puzzle like fashion, we may make an imaginary leap that one shall need to slay HYDRA's heads in order to tackle the puzzle/cipher.

I have to further explore this path but the following notes comes to my mind:

- K4 can be converted to 5 bit binary yielding a 485 bit map. Cutting off the "heads" in a way consistent with the D^YAHR clue would allow us to develop a grille like matrix which could be overlaid on either sections of the Ciphertext, Plaintext or Tableau.
- It remains open if the anagramming of D^YAHR should be literally applied as a step of permutation on the bits taken from K4 characters or if it is just a byproduct from the necessary aligning of K3 to produce the HYDRA hint. Do note that a bit permutation would yield an ordered K4 intermediate text, consistent with the order of the BERLIN clue as no characters from CT would shift position to the final PT.
- The fact that K1 CT begins with EMUF (FUME backwards) is in itself interesting as might relate to the HYDRA mythology of the poisonous fumes of the beast.
- There seems to be some kind of relationship between K1 and K4. In the Antipodes sculpture we do have 2 samples of K4 starting right next to K1 (in both situations with NYPVTT aligned with the beginning of K1). This may hint to some relation between both especially if we take into account the fact that the first occurrence only matches this alignment by virtue of the inserted empty space before the start of K1 and Sanborn choosing NYPVTT for the 2010 hint of BERLIN (NYPVTT starts at the 64th K4 character while K1 is 63 characters long):

E	U	H	E	E	C	D	M	R	I	P	F	E	I	M	E	H	N	L	S	S	T	T	R	T	V	D	O	H	W	?	O	B	K	
R	U	O	X	O	G	H	U	L	B	S	O	L	I	F	B	B	W	F	L	R	V	Q	Q	P	R	N	G	K	S	S	O	T	W	
T	Q	S	J	Q	S	S	E	K	Z	Z	W	A	T	J	K	L	U	D	I	A	W	I	N	F	B	N	Y	P	V	T	T	M	Z	F
P	K	W	G	D	K	Z	X	T	J	C	D	I	G	K	U	H	U	A	U	E	K	C	A	R		E	M	U	F	P	H	Z	L	
R	F	A	X	Y	U	S	D	J	K	Z	L	D	K	R	N	S	H	G	N	F	I	V	J	Y	Q	T	Q	U	X	Q	B	Q	V	

F	E	I	M	E	H	N	L	S	S	T	T	R	T	V	D	O	H	W	?	O	B	K	R	U	O	X	O	G	H	U	L	B	S
O	L	I	F	B	B	W	F	L	R	V	Q	Q	P	R	N	G	K	S	S	O	T	W	T	Q	S	J	Q	S	S	E	K	Z	Z
W	A	T	J	K	L	U	D	I	A	W	I	N	F	B	N	Y	P	V	T	T	M	Z	F	P	K	W	G	D	K	Z	X	T	J
C	D	I	G	K	U	H	U	A	U	E	K	C	A	R	E	M	U	F	P	H	Z	L	R	F	A	X	Y	U	S	D	J	K	Z
L	D	K	R	N	S	H	G	N	F	I	V	J	Y	Q	T	Q	U	X	Q	B	Q	V	Y	U	V	L	L	T	R	E	V	J	Y

I have written some small pieces of code that convert from ASCII to 5-bit binary and back, does bit permutations and many other kinds of manipulations. If anyone has an idea on this line that would like to try but isn't willing to do it by

hand I'd be glad apply it with the tools I have providing it has some justifiable logic beneath it.